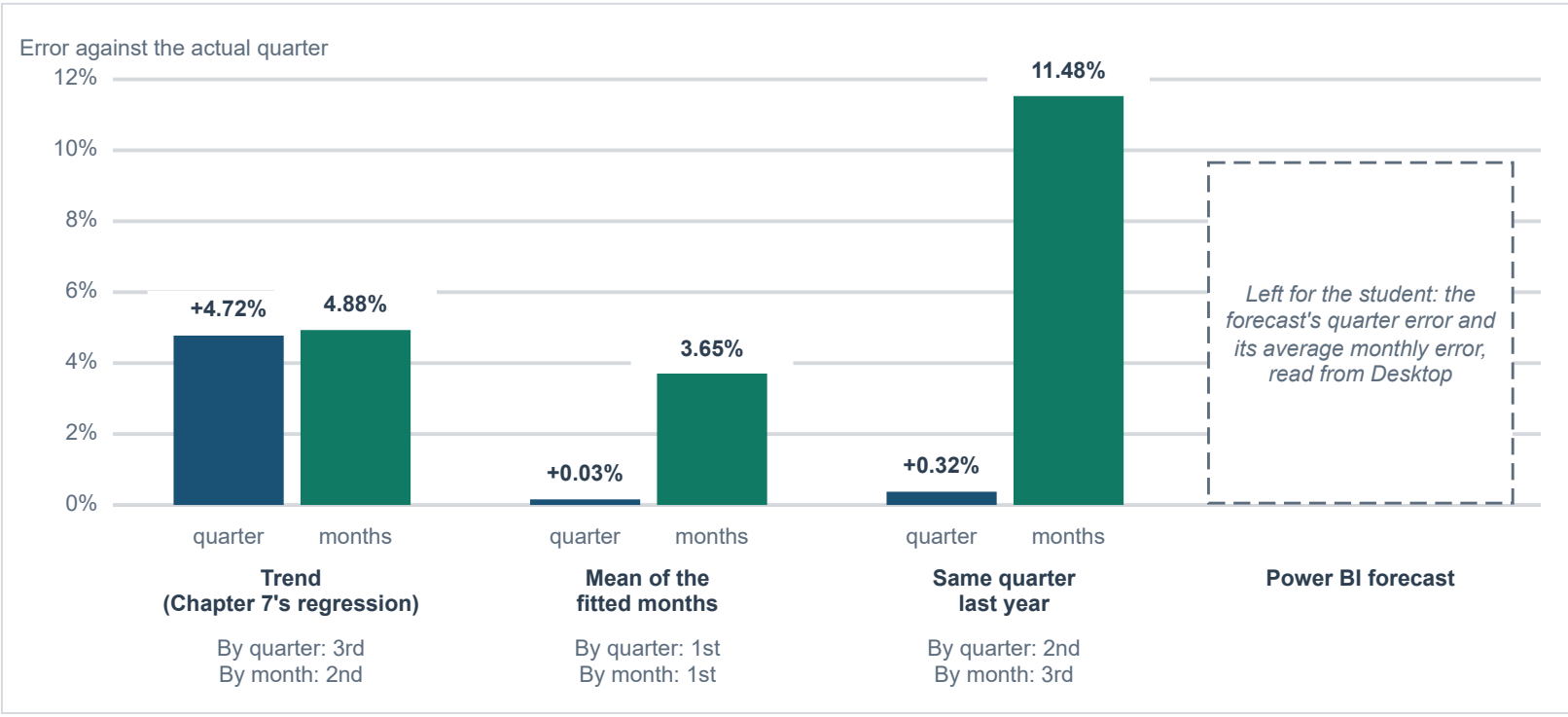
Three benchmarks for the fourth quarter of 2026, by the error of the quarter and by the average error of its months



Error of the quarter total: the forecast total over the actual, less one (plus: too high)

Average error of the three months: the miss of each month over its actual, averaged

Chapter 7's benchmarks for 2026's fourth quarter, fitted from February 2024. By the quarter the mean has the smallest error and the trend the largest; by the month the same quarter last year has the largest, because its months' misses do not net against each other. The mean's quarter bar, +0.03%, is too short to see. Every bar starts at zero.